User Journey Document 02

Save and Share Itinerary by Link

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1. Purpose of this document

This document defines the second key user journey in the travel planning app: enabling a customer to **share a saved itinerary with other people using a link**.

It describes how a customer:

- finishes or opens an itinerary,
- chooses to share it,
- generates a shareable link,
- controls whether it is view-only or collaborative,
- sends it to friends or fellow travelers,
- and how the recipient experiences that shared trip.

This document is intended to work both as:

1. a **customer journey / product requirement document**, and
2. a **handoff input for Figma Make, Replit, Claude, or Codex** to design and implement the journey like a professional consumer app.

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2. Journey name

Journey 2: Save and Share Itinerary by Link

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3. Journey summary

After a customer creates or edits an itinerary, they should be able to save it and share it with friends, family, or co-travelers using a simple link.

The share flow should feel easy and trustworthy. The user should not need to manually export files or explain the trip separately. Instead, the app should generate a structured, mobile-friendly shared trip view that other people can open directly.

The owner of the itinerary should be able to:

- create a shareable link,
- choose sharing permissions,
- copy or send the link,
- understand who can view or collaborate,
- and return to the trip later.

The recipient should be able to:

- open the link,
- view the itinerary in a clean day-by-day format,
- understand who shared it,
- and optionally sign in if they want to save, duplicate, or collaborate.

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4. Why this journey matters

Travel planning is rarely solitary. Even for solo trips, users often want to share their plans with family or friends. For couples, groups, or families, sharing is essential.

This journey matters because it converts a private itinerary into a social and usable trip object.

If done well, it should make the customer feel:

- “I can easily share my plan”
- “My friends can understand this trip quickly”
- “This feels cleaner than sending screenshots or text messages”
- “The app supports real-world travel coordination”

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5. User goal

The user wants to answer a simple question:

“How do I send this trip to someone else in a way that is easy to open and understand?”

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6. Product goal

The system should:

- make sharing effortless,
- preserve the structure and beauty of the itinerary,
- support view-only and optional collaborative modes,
- protect ownership and permissions,
- and create a reusable trip link that works well on mobile.

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7. Start state and end state

Start state

The user already has an itinerary that exists in the system, whether newly created or previously saved.

End state

The user has:

- saved the itinerary if needed,
- created a share link,
- sent or copied the link,
- and the recipient can successfully open and view the trip.

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8. User persona for this journey

This journey is designed for users who:

- want to share a trip with a spouse, partner, friend, or group
- want others to review or react to the plan
- want to keep all trip context in one place

- do not want to send multiple screenshots or manually typed details

This can support:

- couples
- friend groups
- families
- solo travelers sharing with relatives
- trip organizers planning on behalf of others

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9. High-level journey flow

Open Saved Itinerary
→ Tap Share
→ Choose Share Settings
→ Generate Share Link
→ Copy / Send Link
→ Recipient Opens Link
→ Recipient Views Trip
→ Optional: Collaborate / Save Copy / Sign In

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10. Detailed user journey flow

Step 1: Customer opens an itinerary

User intent

The customer wants to share a trip they have created or saved.

User sees

The itinerary detail screen showing:

- trip title
- city
- dates if added
- day-by-day layout

- save status
- edit controls
- share action

User actions

- review itinerary
- edit minor details if needed
- tap share

System response

The app checks whether the trip is saved and whether the user is logged in.

Exit condition

The customer taps the share action.

Step 2: System validates eligibility to share

User intent

The customer expects the trip to be shareable immediately.

System logic

Before sharing, the system should ensure:

- the itinerary exists as a saved object
- the user has a valid account/session
- there is a stable linkable version of the trip

If itinerary is not yet saved

The system should prompt:

- “Save this itinerary to share it”

If user is not logged in

The system should prompt:

- “Sign in or create an account to share your trip”

Exit condition

The user becomes eligible to generate a share link.

Step 3: Customer opens share options

User intent

The customer wants control over how the trip is shared.

User sees

A share sheet or share screen with:

- trip preview card
- share title
- permission options
- link generation CTA
- copy/share controls once generated

User actions

They can choose:

- view-only link
- collaborator link
- maybe “allow suggestions” in future versions
- copy link
- share via native apps

UX goal

This should feel simple, not technical.

Exit condition

The user confirms the share type.

Step 4: Customer generates share link

User intent

The customer wants a usable link immediately.

System response

The system creates a link tied to the itinerary and selected permissions.

User sees

A success state showing:

- “Link created”
- generated share link
- copy button
- native share CTA
- trip preview

User actions

- copy link
- open share sheet
- close and return

Exit condition

The link is copied or shared.

Step 5: Customer sends the itinerary to others

User intent

The customer wants to distribute the trip.

User actions

They may:

- paste the link into WhatsApp
- send through iMessage

- send via email
- share through native app options
- keep the link for later

System expectation

The link should be clean and portable across platforms.

Exit condition

Recipient receives the link.

Step 6: Recipient opens shared link

Recipient intent

The recipient wants to quickly understand the trip.

Recipient sees

A mobile-friendly shared trip page with:

- trip title
- city
- owner name
- day-by-day breakdown
- key highlights
- maybe a hero image or cover
- CTA to open in app

Recipient actions

- scroll itinerary
- view days
- inspect items
- optionally sign in
- duplicate/save their own copy if allowed

UX goal

The recipient should understand the trip without needing prior app knowledge.

Exit condition

The recipient has successfully viewed the trip.

Step 7: Optional collaboration or save-copy behavior

Recipient intent

The recipient may want to:

- save the shared trip
- copy it into their own account
- react to it
- suggest changes

Possible actions

- sign in to collaborate
- duplicate itinerary
- suggest edits
- save to own trips

Recommended MVP behavior

For an initial version:

- support **view-only**
- optionally support **duplicate to my trips**
- keep full collaboration limited or clearly controlled

Exit condition

Recipient either views passively or takes a logged-in action.

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11. Functional requirements

11.1 Share entry requirements

The app must:

- provide a visible share action from itinerary screens
- ensure the itinerary is saved before sharing
- ensure only logged-in users can create links

11.2 Share settings requirements

The app must:

- support at least one link type: view-only
- optionally support collaborator or suggest mode
- make permission state clearly visible

11.3 Link generation requirements

The app must:

- generate a unique, stable trip link
- attach the correct permission level
- provide a copy action
- support native share handoff on mobile

11.4 Shared trip page requirements

The recipient-facing view must:

- load cleanly on mobile
- show itinerary title and ownership context
- display day-by-day structure
- preserve the key information of the original itinerary
- not require login for basic viewing, if public link is allowed

11.5 Ownership and safety requirements

The system must:

- preserve itinerary ownership
- prevent accidental public editing
- clearly show what recipients can and cannot do
- protect private trip data as appropriate

11.6 Duplication / save-copy requirements

If duplication is supported, the system must:

- let recipients save a copy into their own account
- preserve the original owner's itinerary separately
- avoid confusion between original and copied versions

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12. UX principles for this journey

This journey should feel:

Frictionless

Sharing should take only a few taps.

Trustworthy

The user should know exactly what is being shared and with what permissions.

Portable

The shared itinerary should be easy to open from any messaging or sharing channel.

Readable

Recipients should understand the trip without effort.

Controlled

The owner should feel safe that their trip is not being unintentionally changed.

Social but structured

It should feel better than sending screenshots and more organized than a plain message thread.

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13. Screen-by-screen UI specification

Screen 1: Itinerary Detail Screen with Share Entry

Purpose

To give the customer a clear entry point into sharing.

Primary UI blocks

- trip title
- city
- dates and summary
- day-by-day itinerary preview
- edit controls
- save state
- prominent share button

Required actions

- tap share
- edit itinerary
- save itinerary if not saved

Key behavior

If the itinerary is already saved, the share action should feel immediate.

Screen 2: Save-or-Login Gate for Sharing

Purpose

To handle blocked sharing states cleanly.

Trigger conditions

- itinerary not saved
- user not logged in

UI blocks

- short explanation
- primary CTA to save or sign in
- secondary CTA to continue later
- reassurance about why this is required

Example copy

- “Save this itinerary to create a shareable link”
- “Create an account to share your trip with others”

UX rule

This should feel like enablement, not a roadblock.

Screen 3: Share Options Screen / Share Sheet

Purpose

To let the customer choose how the trip is shared.

UI blocks

- trip preview card
- title: Share itinerary
- permission selector
- description of access level
- generate link CTA

Suggested options

- View only
- Can suggest changes
- Can collaborate fully (future or advanced version)

Recommended MVP

Keep only:

- View only
- Duplicate to own trips after sign-in

Required actions

- choose permission
- generate link
- cancel

Screen 4: Link Created Success State

Purpose

To confirm that sharing is ready.

UI blocks

- success message
- sharable link field
- copy button
- native share button
- small trip preview
- permission badge

Required actions

- copy link
- share via apps
- done / close

UX note

This moment should feel polished and satisfying.

Screen 5: Native Share Handoff

Purpose

To hand the generated link into the device’s standard sharing system.

Behavior

The app should invoke native share options such as:

- WhatsApp
- Messages
- Mail
- Notes
- other installed apps

UX note

This does not need custom design beyond initiation, but should be included in the prototype flow as a transition state.

Screen 6: Recipient Shared Itinerary View

Purpose

To let recipients consume the trip clearly.

UI blocks

- shared-by label
- trip title
- city
- dates if available
- day tabs or stacked day sections
- itinerary item blocks
- open in app CTA
- sign-in CTA if deeper action is available

Itinerary item content

- order/time
- place name
- place type
- duration or visit hint
- meal tag if relevant

Required behavior

The page should be readable even if the recipient is not logged in.

Screen 7: Save Copy / Collaborate Prompt

Purpose

To convert shared-trip viewers into active users when relevant.

Trigger

Recipient taps:

- save trip
- duplicate trip
- suggest edits
- collaborate

UI blocks

- explanation
- sign-in/create-account CTA
- benefit summary

Example copy

- “Save this trip to your account”
- “Create your own editable copy”

Screen 8: Duplicate to My Trips Confirmation

Purpose

To confirm that the recipient has saved their own version.

UI blocks

- success confirmation
- new trip title
- open trip CTA
- note that original remains unchanged

14. Information architecture for the shared trip

The shared itinerary view should preserve the following structure:

Header

- trip title
- city
- cover image optional
- owner name
- date summary

Trip summary

- number of days
- number of places
- travel style or pace if available

Day structure

- Day 1, Day 2, Day 3 sections
- place sequence within each day

Item blocks

- place name
- category
- duration
- notes if relevant
- meal labeling if applicable

Footer actions

- open in app
- sign in to save or duplicate

- maybe share onward

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15. Edge cases and states

Itinerary not saved yet

The app should stop direct sharing and require save first.

User not logged in

The app should require login before link creation.

Link generation fails

Show:

- “We couldn’t create your link”
- retry CTA
- return to itinerary

Share permission confusion

The permission should always be visible next to the link.

Recipient opens expired or revoked link

Show a clean error state:

- “This trip link is no longer available”

Recipient has no app installed

The shared itinerary should still open in a mobile-friendly web view.

Owner updates itinerary after sharing

The product should define whether the shared link reflects the latest version or a snapshot. Recommended early approach: shared link points to the latest saved version unless snapshot mode is explicitly introduced later.

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16. What the customer should feel during this journey

The customer should feel:

- “I can share this trip in seconds”
- “This looks polished enough to send to other people”
- “My friends will understand this easily”
- “I’m in control of who can do what”
- “This is better than sending screenshots”

The recipient should feel:

- “This trip is clear and well-organized”
- “I can quickly see the plan day by day”
- “I know who shared this”
- “I can use this trip without confusion”

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17. Acceptance criteria

This journey is successful if the user can:

1. open an itinerary and find the share action
2. save the itinerary if needed
3. log in if required
4. generate a shareable link
5. copy or send the link
6. have the recipient open and understand the trip
7. optionally allow the recipient to duplicate or save the trip

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18. Handoff prompt for Figma Make / Replit / AI design tools

Use this prompt to generate the detailed design flow:

> Design a premium mobile-first travel app flow for sharing an itinerary by link. The user opens a saved itinerary and taps a clear share button. If needed, the app asks them to save the itinerary or sign in before sharing. Then the user sees a polished share sheet with a trip preview and permission options, at minimum including a view-only link. After generating the link, the app shows a success state with the sharable URL, a copy button, and a native share button. The recipient-facing shared trip view should be mobile-friendly and show the trip title, city, owner name, date summary if available, and a day-by-day itinerary layout with structured place blocks. The recipient should be able to view the trip without confusion and optionally sign in to duplicate the trip into their own account. The design should feel modern, premium, simple, trustworthy, and suitable for a polished consumer travel app.